APOTI DEVELOPMENT ASSOCIATION

First Widow Home Visits
Terms of Reference

ADA/2021/001 · November 1–30, 2021 (1 month) · Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon

Retrospective review copy (November 2026): This document was updated later to record owner-recalled financial information. Its original issue date is historical metadata; this review does not independently verify the project narrative or establish an approved budget.

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REFERENCE
ADA/2021/001

LOCATION
Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon

PERIOD
November 1–30, 2021 (1 month)

BUDGET / SPEND
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Terms of Reference (ToR)

First Widow Home Visits Programme

FIELD	DETAILS
Project Reference	ADA/2021/001
Project Title	First Widow Home Visits
Implementing Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Location	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Duration	November 1–30, 2021 (1 month)
Financial note	Owner later recalled 120,000 CFA sent (approximately US$209 using the November 2021 monthly average); this is not a verified project budget.
Date Issued	October 15, 2021

Retrospective review copy (November 2026): This document was updated later to record owner-recalled financial information. Its original issue date is historical metadata; this review does not independently verify the project narrative or establish an approved budget.

1. Background & Context

Widows in Cameroon, particularly in the South-West Region, face severe socio-economic marginalization. Cultural practices often strip widows of inheritance rights, leaving elderly women without land, shelter, or financial resources after the death of a spouse. In rural communities surrounding Buea, widows who have outlived their extended family networks are among the most invisible and vulnerable members of society — often surviving on the charity of neighbours or subsisting on less than one meal per day.

The ongoing Anglophone crisis, which escalated from 2016 onward, has compounded these vulnerabilities. Displacement, destruction of livelihoods, and the breakdown of community support structures have left many elderly widows completely isolated. Young family members who might have provided care have fled to francophone regions or abroad. Health facilities and social services in the South-West Region operate at reduced capacity, and government social safety nets remain virtually non-existent for this demographic. Elderly widows living alone face food insecurity, untreated illness, and profound emotional distress with no institutional recourse.

It is within this context that the Apoti Development Association (ADA) was founded in 2021 with a mission to serve the most vulnerable. This inaugural project — the First Widow Home Visits — represents ADA's founding intervention: a direct, community-based response to identify and support elderly widows living in extreme poverty in the Buea municipality. The project addresses immediate food needs while establishing a baseline understanding of the living conditions and support requirements of this population.

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2. Project Objectives

General Objective

To provide immediate humanitarian relief and psychosocial support to elderly widows living alone in extreme poverty in Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon.

Specific Objectives

1. **SO1:** To deliver food assistance (rice packages) to at least 3 identified elderly widows within their homes during November 2021.
2. **SO2:** To conduct needs assessments of the living conditions, health status, and support networks of each beneficiary widow.
3. **SO3:** To provide emotional and spiritual support through prayer, companionship, and active listening during home visits.
4. **SO4:** To document the conditions of vulnerable widows in the community as a foundation for future programme design and advocacy.

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3. Target Beneficiaries

Primary Beneficiaries

CRITERION	DETAIL
Number	3 elderly widows
Gender	Female
Age	60 years and above
Location	Rural and peri-urban Buea
Status	Widowed, living alone or with dependents (e.g., grandchildren)

Selection Criteria

Beneficiaries shall be identified through community referral and must meet the following criteria:

- Widowed (husband deceased)
- Living alone or as sole caregiver for minor dependents
- No regular income or family financial support
- Residing in substandard or precarious housing
- Experiencing food insecurity
- Identified by community members, church leaders, or neighbours as being in urgent need

Indirect Beneficiaries

- Dependents living with the widows (e.g., grandchildren)
- Surrounding community members who benefit from awareness raised about widow vulnerability

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4. Scope of Work / Activities

The project shall undertake the following activities:

4.1 Beneficiary Identification & Mapping

- Engage community leaders, church pastors, and neighbours to identify eligible widows
- Verify eligibility through brief community consultations
- Map locations of identified beneficiaries for visit planning

4.2 Procurement of Relief Items

- Purchase 25kg bags of rice (one per beneficiary household)
- Procure supplementary food items as available project funds allow (cooking oil, salt)
- Prepare food packages for distribution

4.3 Home Visits & Food Delivery

- Conduct door-to-door visits to each identified widow
- Deliver food packages directly to beneficiary homes
- Ensure dignified and respectful delivery process

4.4 Needs Assessment

- Observe and document housing conditions (structure, roofing, sanitation)
- Assess health status and mobility of each beneficiary
- Identify immediate and longer-term needs (medical, shelter, food security)
- Record number and status of dependents

4.5 Psychosocial & Spiritual Support

- Provide prayer and spiritual encouragement
- Offer companionship and active listening
- Assess emotional well-being and signs of isolation or distress

4.6 Documentation & Reporting

- Photograph living conditions (with consent)
- Complete beneficiary assessment forms
- Compile visit reports and project completion report

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5. Expected Outcomes & Indicators

EXPECTED OUTCOME	INDICATOR	MEANS OF VERIFICATION
3 elderly widows receive food assistance	Number of food packages delivered	Distribution records, delivery receipts
Living conditions of beneficiaries are documented	Number of needs assessment forms completed	Completed assessment forms
Beneficiaries receive emotional/spiritual support	Number of prayer and counselling sessions conducted	Visit reports, volunteer logs
Baseline data established for future programming	Project completion report produced with recommendations	Final report document
ADA establishes community presence	Number of community contacts made during identification phase	Community referral records

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6. Timeline & Milestones

WEEK	DATES	ACTIVITIES	MILESTONE
Week 1	Nov 1–7, 2021	Community engagement; beneficiary identification and verification; visit planning	Beneficiary list finalized
Week 2	Nov 8–14, 2021	Procurement of rice and food items; preparation of food packages; logistics planning	Food packages prepared
Week 3	Nov 15–21, 2021	Home visits to Beneficiary 1 and Beneficiary 2; food delivery; needs assessment; prayer support	2 visits completed
Week 4	Nov 22–30, 2021	Home visit to Beneficiary 3; food delivery; needs assessment; documentation compilation; project report drafting	All visits completed; report submitted

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7. Financial Information — Under Review

The original itemized budget table has been withheld because its line-item allocations and USD conversion are not independently supported. The owner later recalled that 120,000 CFA francs was sent for the project. This after-the-fact recollection does not establish the approved budget or validate individual planned allocations. See the separate Financial Review Note for the owner-recalled amounts and reconciliation limits.

8. Implementation Approach

Methodology

The project employs a **door-to-door, faith-based, community-referral** approach:

1. **Community Referral:** Beneficiaries are identified through trusted community networks — church leaders, neighbours, and local women's groups — rather than through formal registration systems that may exclude the most isolated individuals.
2. **Door-to-Door Delivery:** All services are delivered directly at the beneficiary's home. This approach recognizes that elderly widows with mobility challenges or caregiving responsibilities cannot travel to distribution points.
3. **Faith-Based Framework:** As a faith-based organization, ADA integrates prayer and spiritual support into its service delivery. This is offered respectfully and in accordance with each beneficiary's wishes.
4. **Dignity-Centred:** Visits are conducted with respect for the autonomy and dignity of each beneficiary. Assistance is offered, not imposed. Consent is obtained for all documentation.
5. **Volunteer-Driven:** The project is implemented by a team of 3 dedicated volunteers, ensuring low overhead and direct community engagement.

Team Composition

ROLE	NUMBER	RESPONSIBILITIES
Project Coordinator	1	Overall coordination, community liaison, reporting
Field Volunteers	2	Home visits, food delivery, needs assessment, documentation

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9. Monitoring & Evaluation

Monitoring Framework

LEVEL	ACTIVITY	FREQUENCY	RESPONSIBLE
Input	Budget tracking, procurement verification	Weekly	Project Coordinator
Process	Visit completion tracking, volunteer debriefs	After each visit	Project Coordinator
Output	Delivery confirmation, forms completion	After each visit	Field Volunteers
Outcome	Beneficiary feedback (verbal)	During visits	Field Volunteers

Evaluation Approach

- **Post-visit debrief:** Team discussion after each home visit to capture observations and lessons learned
- **Beneficiary feedback:** Verbal feedback collected from widows during visits regarding satisfaction and additional needs
- **End-of-project review:** Team meeting to assess achievement against objectives and document recommendations for future projects

Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if:

- All 3 identified beneficiaries receive food packages
- Needs assessment forms are completed for each beneficiary
- A project completion report with recommendations is produced within 2 weeks of project end
- At least 2 actionable recommendations for future programming are identified

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10. Reporting Requirements

REPORT	CONTENT	DUE DATE	RECIPIENT
Beneficiary Assessment Forms	Individual living conditions, health, needs	Within 48 hours of each visit	Project files
Visit Reports	Summary of each home visit, observations, items delivered	Within 1 week of each visit	ADA Executive Director
Project Completion Report	Full narrative report including: context, activities undertaken, outcomes achieved, lessons learned, recommendations, financial summary, photos	December 15, 2021	ADA Board, project files
Financial Report	Itemized expenditure against budget, receipts	December 15, 2021	ADA Executive Director

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11. Implementing Organization

FIELD	DETAILS
Name	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Type	Faith-based non-governmental organization
Year Founded	2021
Registration	Registered in Cameroon
Mission	Empowering vulnerable communities through faith-based programmes supporting widows, orphans, and young women
Headquarters	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Email	info@apotidev.org
Phone	+237 676 282 346 (WhatsApp)
Website	https://apotidev.org

Organizational Mandate

ADA was established in 2021 to address the needs of the most vulnerable populations in Cameroon's South-West Region, with a particular focus on widows, orphans, and young women at risk. As a grassroots, faith-based organization, ADA operates through direct community engagement, volunteer mobilization, and partnerships with local churches and community leaders.

This project — ADA/2021/001 — represents the organization's founding intervention and establishes the operational model for future programming.

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12. Risks & Assumptions

Assumptions

- Community leaders and church networks will cooperate in identifying eligible beneficiaries

- Identified widows will consent to receive visits and assistance
- Road and transport conditions in Buea will permit access to beneficiary locations during November
- Market prices for food items will remain stable during the procurement period
- Volunteers will remain available for the full project duration

Risks & Mitigation

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Security deterioration due to Anglophone crisis restricts movement	Medium	High	Monitor security situation weekly; postpone visits if unsafe; identify alternative access routes
Identified beneficiaries refuse assistance or are unavailable	Low	Medium	Maintain a reserve list of eligible widows; reschedule visits as needed
Market price increases exceed budget	Low	Medium	Procure early in project cycle; adjust quantities within available project funds
Volunteer attrition	Low	Medium	Brief additional community members as standby volunteers
Adverse weather limits access to rural locations	Medium	Low	Schedule visits on dry days; allow flexibility in weekly planning

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13. Approval

This Terms of Reference is hereby approved for implementation.

Project Coordinator

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Executive Director, Apoti Development Association

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Document Reference: ADA/2021/001/ToR Version: 1.0 Date Issued: October 15, 2021

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